THE FAPS CHRONICLES

NOV WEEK 1 • COURAGE IS DESTINY • 9TH NOVEMBER2026

EXPRESSIONS!

The school grounds were filled with pure excitement as students, teachers and the interact club gathered for our annual fest, Expressions.

Right from early morning, the organizing committee, student council, and student volunteers were running around setting up tables, hanging colorful decorations, testing sound systems, and organizing the entry gates.

One of the absolute sweetest parts of the day was seeing the students from lower grades running their own small booths with massive smiles, handling money, talking to customers, and showing off impressive confidence.

The huge variety of stalls was a total hit, offering delicious homemade snacks, cold drinks, craft booths, and little pop-up shops.







Students from several visiting schools streamed through the gates to join in on the fun, while many of our past graduates and alumni returned to campus to cheer everyone on, and serve as judges.

Down on the open field and outdoor courts, the **football and basketball** tournaments drew loud, cheering crowds as players gave it their absolute all.

Over on the main stage, the **Fashion Show** was a huge crowd-puller, where teams walked the runway in creative outfits.

For those who preferred solving puzzles over sports, the students also hosted a **Murder Mystery** event, where participants acted like detectives, piecing together tricky clues, analizing evidence, and racing against the clock to solve the case.

Meanwhile, commerce students got their turn to shine in **Venture wars**, a business competition where young entrepreneurs pitched original startup ideas and answered tough questions from a panel of judges.



The energy didn't drop for a single second as the rest of the competitions unfolded across the school buildings.

The **Mad Ads** competition had the entire audience laughing out loud, the **Personality** contest tested individual participants on their quick thinking, charm, and composure through a series of funny and challenging Q&A rounds.

Dancers brought incredible high energy to the floor during **Elàn**, performing syncronized routines to upbeat music that had the crowd standing up and cheering after every single song.

In **Market Masters**, teams used ₹10,00,000 in virtual capital to bid on business assets and outsmart competitors.



In **The Last Verdict**, participants stepped back in time to bring major historical legal cases to life. Given a surprise case on the spot, teams acted as opposing counsels to analyze facts, research the law, and defend their case under pressure.



The **Drums n' Roses** was a great event for the student who wanted to showcase their music talent.

By the time the final awards were handed out and the music stopped, the sheer teamwork, dedication, and spirit of the entire school had turned this year's festival into an unforgettable success.

Butterfly

~By Sreemayi Pradeep (9 'A')

Butterfly I am a butterfly with beautiful wings that enhance the colors
of my love for the world.
I am a butterfly: from being a cocoon. I saw my wings being unfurled.
I fly freely. Worrying about nobody.
I fly everywhere. from cities to forests.
But my home. the orange tree. looked the brightest.

I fly around the park. and my wings flutter.
I see a girl. and I sit on her arm: she sees me.
And smiles in glee. But one move and I fly and disappear.

Old women sit alone. desolate and pessimistic.
I must say. They don't deserve it. as it is a beautiful day.
I sit on the edge of the bench. sitting next to them.
Just so they know that I fly with them.

I have no one at the end of the day.
But the smiles on people's faces are what I need.
I will stay with people if they need me to be there all day.
I will dance and fly because I am. for once. freed.

I am a butterfly. and this is my story.
Nothing much to see. but I am happy.
I have no pride or glory. As I am merely a butterfly.
With a tiny little heart filled with a lot of love.

WEIRD BUT TRUE!

On Saturn and Jupiter, it literally rains diamonds. Extreme atmospheric pressure crushes carbon gas into solid chunks of diamond, which fall through the sky like hailstones into the deep ocean cores.





Trees can actually communicate and protect each other. Using a vast underground network of fungus roots, they share essential nutrients and warn neighboring trees about incoming insect attacks or severe droughts.

The mighty Napoleon Bonaparte was once defeated by bunnies. In 1807, when thousands of tame rabbits were released for a hunt, they mistook Napoleon for their feeder and aggressively swarmed his legs, forcing the fierce emperor to flee in his carriage.





The shortest war in human history lasted just 38 minutes. In 1896, the British Empire clashed with the island of Zanzibar. Before the clock could even hit an hour, Zanzibar surrendered, ending the conflict in record time.

A blue whale's heart is as big as a car. It weighs nearly 180 kilograms, and its massive heartbeat is so incredibly loud that scientists can **easily detect it from two kilometres away.**



THAT'S CONCERNING...

IS SLEEP *THAT* IMPORTANT?

There is a toxic badge of honor floating around Indian schools and coaching centers: the idea that sleeping four hours makes you a warrior, and surviving on sheer caffeine and panic is proof of your ambition.

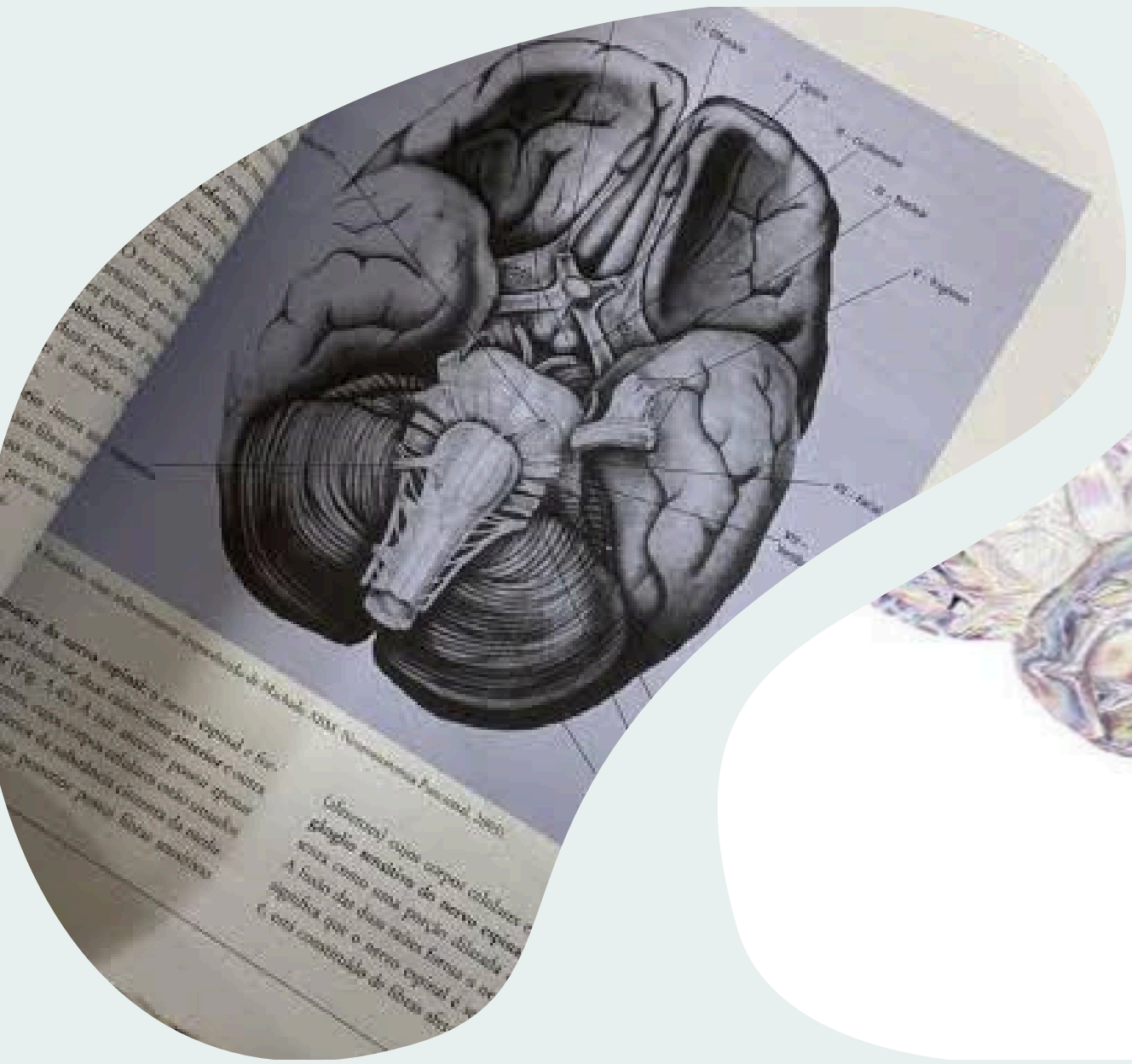
It's actually a scam you're running on yourself.

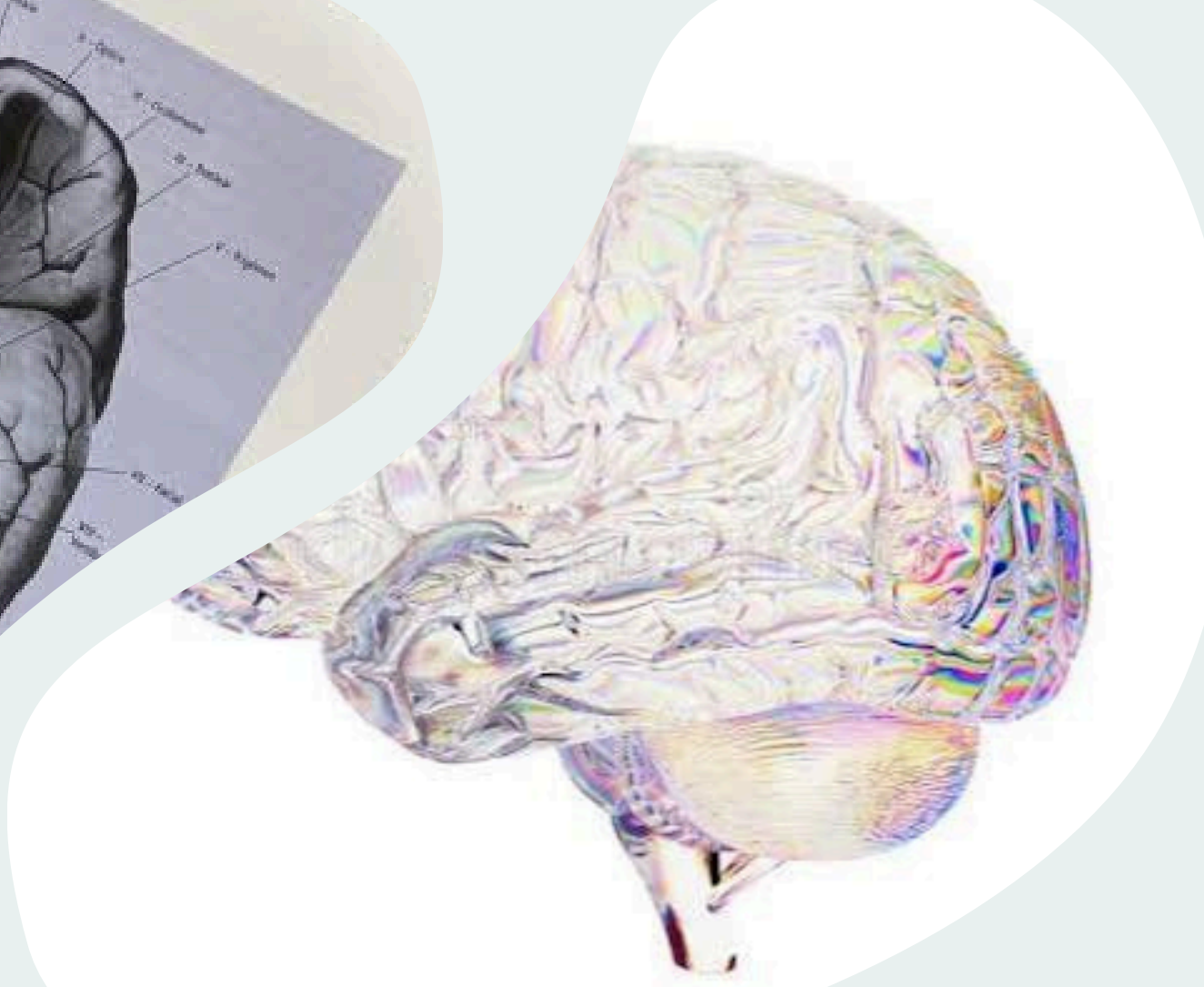
When you stay up until 2:00 AM cramming physics derivations or accountancy formats, you aren't outworking your competition—you are literally sabotaging your own hardware.





Neuroscience shows that the brain does not permanently store what you study while you're studying it. That transfer happens exclusively during slow-wave and REM sleep, where your hippocampus replays and cements new concepts into long-term memory. Skimping on sleep to study more is like typing a brilliant 2,000-word essay and repeatedly slamming the laptop shut without hitting "Save."





Meanwhile, your brain's glymphatic system—essentially the biological night-shift cleaning crew—only activates while you are in deep slumber to flush out neurotoxic metabolic waste. Skip that cycle, and your prefrontal cortex operates the next day in a state equivalent to being legally intoxicated. Your reaction speed drops, your focus dissolves, and those silly mistakes on test papers that make you kick yourself? That isn't bad luck. That's a starved, unwashed brain misfiring under pressure.

STUDENTS AWAIT GTA 6...

GLOBAL SPORTS

HARRY KANE, ALEXIA PUTELLAS CROWNED 2026 BALLON D'OR CHAMPIONS

Bayern Munich striker Harry Kane claimed the Men's Ballon d'Or for the first time, edging out Real Madrid's Kylian Mbappé by just 28 points. The English captain secured the trophy after scoring an extraordinary 73 goals for club and country. Meanwhile, Barcelona midfielder Alexia Putellas won the Ballon d'Or Féminin, capturing the prestigious women's crown for the third time in her historic career.





INDIA MEN'S HOCKEY DOMINATES ASIAN CHAMPIONS TROPHY CAMPAIGN

The Indian Men's Field Hockey team extended their flawless run at the Asian Champions Trophy with consecutive high-scoring masterclasses. Showcasing clinical drag-flicking and lethal counter-attacks, the Men in Blue cruised past rivals Japan 4-1 before dismantling China 5-2. Anchored by aggressive baseline pressing, the undefeated squad sits firmly at the top of the group standings heading into the knockout tournament phases.

CURRENT SCIENCE



ISRO ACES SATELLITE LAUNCH

India's space agency, ISRO, is preparing to launch its next-generation navigation satellite, NVS-03, aboard the powerful GSLV-F18 rocket. **This mission represents a massive upgrade for the country's indigenous NavIC constellation, which provides precision positioning across the region.** Positioned in a geosynchronous orbit, the advanced satellite carries a highly accurate atomic clock to ensure seamless tracking and timing data. By expanding coverage and enhancing signal reliability for civilian and strategic users alike, this launch **marks a crucial step forward in India's quest for technological independence,** sharpening its eyes in the sky and securing its place among elite spacefaring nations.

MEET THE SUPER MAGNET

Scientists recently confirmed a brand-new, third type of magnetism called **altermagnetism**.

Until now, we mostly knew about regular magnets that stick to fridges (ferromagnets) and hidden magnets that cancel themselves out (antiferromagnets).

Altermagnets are a special hybrid of both. On the outside, they have no magnetic pull, meaning they won't stick to your fridge. But on the inside, they possess a unique, twisted structure that allows electricity to flow through them at lightning speeds.

This discovery will help engineers build ultra-fast computers and smartphones that **never overheat**, making electronics much more powerful and energy-efficient for the future.



STUDENTS' VOICE

WHAT'S THE GENERAL OPINION ABOUT THE SCHOOL'S SCIENCE LABS?

SCHOOL LABS, I WOULD NOT SAY THEY'RE WELL MAINTAINED, BUT THEY'RE DECENT. AT LEAST IN OUR SCHOOL THEY TRY THEIR BEST TO KEEP IT UP TO BASIC STANDARDS; IT'S NOT THAT GOOD, BUT IT'S THERE.

WHY DO YOU THINK WE ARE NOT TAKEN TO THE LABS VERY OFTEN?

IT'S BECAUSE OF THE PEOPLE IN FAPS. OUR SCHOOL IS VERY LENIENT, AND THERE ARE CERTAIN PEOPLE FROM CLASSES WHO WILL END UP MESSING UP THINGS IN THE LAB OR BREAKING SOMETHING. THAT'S WHY.

HOW DO YOU THINK THE LABS COULD BECOME BETTER?

THEY CAN BE UPGRADED BY ADDING NEW EQUIPMENT TO THEM. IT'S MOSTLY USED BY 11TH AND 12TH GRADERS SO IT MATCHES THAT STANDARD, BUT IN OUR WHOLE SCHOOL LIFE, I'VE ONLY BEEN TAKEN ONCE IN 10TH GRADE.

-ANGAD SINGH (CLASS 11 SCIENCE)

THE SCHOOL LABS ARE LOWKEY BAD, HONESTLY, BECAUSE THEY NEVER TAKE US! THERE'S NO POINT TO THEM IF THEY NEVER TAKE US.

WHY DO YOU THINK THEY NEVER TAKE US?

THEY PROBABLY DON'T TRUST US. KNOWING FAPS KIDS, THEY'RE **GOING TO BURN THE SCHOOL DOWN!** THE CHEM LAB LOOKS LIKE IT COULD BURN THE SCHOOL DOWN TOO.

WHAT ABOUT THE OTHER LABS, LIKE THE BIOLOGY AND PHYSICS LABS?

THE BIO LAB IS GOATED BECAUSE OF SREEJA MA'AM, BUT THE PHYSICS LAB IS JUST THERE BECAUSE ARUN KUMAR SIR JUST SITS THERE.

WOULD TAKING STUDENTS TO LABS IN LOWER GRADES HELP THEM CHOOSE SCIENCE AS THEIR STREAM?

PROBABLY NOT, BECAUSE THEY ARE NOT GOING TO UNDERSTAND BASIC EXPERIMENTS. KIDS WILL **JUST MIX RANDOM THINGS** LIKE HYDROCHLORIC ACID AND OTHER ACIDS, MAKE RANDOM ANSWERS, AND BURN THE SCHOOL DOWN!

-MATHIEU VANBUERLE (CLASS 9C)

EVERY TIME I ENTER THE PHYSICS LAB THERE'S LIKE **NOTHING ON THE TABLE**—IT LOOKS **LIKE A DINING TABLE! MY FRIEND IS LITERALLY HAVING A NICE MEAL EVERY TIME I WALK IN THERE**. WHAT THE HELL IS HAPPENING, DUDE? IT'S A PHYSICS LAB, NOT A DINING LAB!

DO YOU THINK WE SHOULD BE TAKEN TO THE LABS MORE OFTEN?

DEFINITELY! WE GET TO SEE MORE PRACTICALITY INSTEAD OF JUST READING THEORY AND TRYING TO IMAGINE THAT IN OUR HEAD. WE LOWKEY **NEED TO SEE IT IN PERSON**, IN PERSPECTIVE—JUST WITHOUT MY FRIEND EATING THERE.

HOW DO YOU THINK THE LABS CAN BECOME BETTER?

THE PHYSICS LAB NEEDS MORE APPARATUSES. FOR THE CHEMISTRY LAB, WE NEED TO BE TAKEN THERE MORE SO STUDENTS CAN PERFORM EXPERIMENTS AND SEE THE PRACTICALITY OF IT, INSTEAD OF JUST MEMORISING COLOURS AND IDENTITY TESTS.

WHY DO YOU THINK WE ARE NOT TAKEN THAT OFTEN?

BECAUSE WE HAVE PEOPLE LIKE MY FRIEND WHO WILL **JUST STRAIGHT UP DRINK ALL THE CHEMICALS**!

-JAIRUS REMIGUS MOTHA (CLASS 10C)

THE LABS ARE ACTUALLY QUITE GOOD, BUT THE ONLY THING IS WE'RE NOT ALLOWED TO GO THERE VERY MUCH—ONLY 11TH AND 12TH GRADERS ARE ALLOWED. CONSIDERING THAT IN OTHER SCHOOLS YOU CAN GO TO THE LABS EVEN FROM 9TH GRADE, IT ISN'T A VERY GOOD FEATURE TO HAVE THEM AND THEN NOT USE THEM.

DO YOU THINK STUDENTS SHOULD BE TAKEN TO THE LAB IN 7TH AND 8TH GRADE TO HELP THEM CHOOSE THEIR STREAM?

NO, NOT REALLY. IN 7TH AND 8TH, PHYSICS IS JUST HEATING SOLIDS, LIQUIDS, AND GASES, AND CHEMISTRY IS BASIC EQUATIONS. AND WHAT DO YOU EVEN DO IN THE BIO LAB? SHOW THEM A SNAKE? EVEN US 9TH AND 10TH GRADERS, ALL WE DO IN THE BIO LAB IS **JUST NAME THE SKELETON "DINESH"—THAT'S ABOUT IT!**

WHY ARE WE NEVER TAKEN TO THE CHEM LAB?

MAINLY BECAUSE OF CHEMICALS! MOST OF US JOKE ABOUT BOMBS WITHOUT KNOWING THE DESTRUCTION OF THEM, SO THE MOMENT WE STEP FOOT INTO THE LAB, IT **WOULDN'T TAKE MUCH FOR SOMEONE TO MIX A FEW CHEMICALS TOGETHER AND JUST BOOM**. THE CHEMISTRY TEACHERS DEFINITELY CANNOT HANDLE US.

-SAMARTH SHENOY (CLASS 10B)

ALL OF THEM ARE GOOD—THEY ARE ALL **NICE AND MAINTAINED,** BUT I WISH WE COULD USE THEM MORE OFTEN. I WISH THEY WERE MORE INVOLVED IN OUR DAY-TO-DAY ACTIVITIES AND WE WERE TAKEN TO THE LABS A **BIT MORE FOR LEARNING.**

WHY DO YOU THINK WE ARE NOT TAKEN VERY OFTEN?

BECAUSE THE ICSE SYLLABUS DOESN'T REQUIRE THAT MUCH LAB WORK, AND **DEMONSTRATIONS ARE USUALLY SHOWN ON SMART TVS IN EACH CLASS**. STILL, PHYSICAL LAB WORK WHERE WE DO REACTIONS **UNDER SUPERVISION WOULD HELP US UNDERSTAND TOPICS A LOT MORE.**

WHY ARE WE NEVER TAKEN TO THE CHEM LAB?

THERE ARE SO MANY CHEMICALS THERE AND YOU KNOW HOW NOTORIOUS SOME PEOPLE CAN BE. SO JUST TAKE THE SMART PEOPLE! AM I REFERRING TO MYSELF? MAYBE! BUT I SAY JUST TAKE THE SMART PEOPLE. IF THERE ARE ANY DAMAGES, WE PAY FOR IT; THAT'S THE ONLY VALID WAY TO DO IT.

WOULD BEING TAKEN TO THE LAB IN 7TH OR 8TH GRADE HELP STUDENTS CHOOSE THEIR STREAM?

YES, DEFINITELY. WHEN YOU PRACTICALLY DO STUFF IN A LAB, YOU ACTUALLY FEEL WHETHER **YOU'RE KEEN ON DOING SCIENCE OR NOT.**

-ISHAAN BOHRA (CLASS 10A)

I THINK THE SCIENCE LAB IS VERY NICE, THE EQUIPMENT ARE WELL ORGANIZED, AND **THEY ARE WELL MAINTAINED**. BUT I FEEL LIKE THERE SHOULD BE MORE SCIENCE LAB CLASSES BECAUSE THEY ARE NOT WELL UTILIZED—WE SHOULD GO AT LEAST TWO TIMES A WEEK.

HOW DO YOU THINK THE LABS CAN BECOME BETTER?

MAYBE WE CAN ADD MORE **AI AND MAKE IT AI-POWERED**! MAYBE ADD A TV IN THE LAB ALSO... WAIT, THERE IS A TV IN THE LAB? MY BAD! I MEAN, YEAH, THAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU'RE NOT TAKEN TO THE LAB OFTEN!

WHAT DO YOU THINK ABOUT THE MYSTERY OF THE CHEM LAB AND WHY AREN'T WE TAKEN THERE?

I THINK THE CHEMISTRY LAB IS WAY TOO DANGEROUS FOR 8TH AND 9TH GRADERS, AND T**HERE ARE MANY NAUGHTY CHILDREN WHO MIGHT TOUCH THE WRONG CHEMICALS**! BUT TAKING STUDENTS IN BATCHES UNDER THE CHEMISTRY TEACHER'S SUPERVISION WOULD WORK.

-NEERAJ K (CLASS 10A)

THE CHEM LAB IS THE MOST INTERESTING LAB IN THE SCHOOL, BUT WE HARDLY EVER SEE IT. IT'S **FULL OF EQUIPMENT AND EXPERIMENTS** THAT WE ONLY READ ABOUT IN TEXTBOOKS, AND **THAT FEELS LIKE A WASTE.**

WHY ARE WE NEVER TAKEN TO THE CHEM LAB?
BECAUSE OF THE CHEMICALS. EVERYONE KNOWS HOW RISKY IT CAN BE IF A CLASS GOES IN WITHOUT PROPER SUPERVISION, AND **ONE WRONG MIX CAN TURN INTO A BIG PROBLEM**. I UNDERSTAND WHY TEACHERS ARE CAREFUL, BUT NOT GOING AT ALL ISN'T THE ANSWER EITHER.

HOW DO YOU THINK THE LABS CAN BECOME BETTER?
THE CHEM LAB NEEDS A **DEDICATED IN-CHARGE**, SOMEONE WHOSE JOB IS TO LOOK AFTER IT, **KEEP TRACK OF THE CHEMICALS AND EQUIPMENT, AND SUPERVISE STUDENTS DURING EXPERIMENTS**. THAT WAY TEACHERS WOULDN'T HAVE TO WORRY ABOUT SAFETY, AND MORE CLASSES COULD ACTUALLY GO.

DO YOU THINK WE SHOULD BE TAKEN TO THE LABS MORE OFTEN?
YES. WE SHOULD HAVE A LAB CLASS AFTER EVERY 5 REGULAR CLASSES. THAT'S REGULAR ENOUGH THAT WE'D GET REAL PRACTICE, AND IT STILL LEAVES PLENTY OF TIME FOR THEORY. **SEEING A REACTION HAPPEN IS SO MUCH BETTER THAN MEMORIZING IT.**

-KARAN (CLASS 10B

TEACHER'S THOUGHTS

I WON'T BE ABLE TO COMMENT ON THE PHYSICS OR THE CHEM LAB, BUT THE BIO LAB CERTAINLY. IN GENERAL, WHAT I FEEL IS THAT LABORATORIES ARE EXTREMELY IMPORTANT, AND THE EXPOSURE YOU GET IN THE LAB IS INVALUABLE. PERSONALLY, THROUGHOUT MY LIFE, I HAVE LOVED THE LABS MORE THAN MY THEORY CLASSES BECAUSE YOU GET TO EXPLORE SO MANY THINGS. AS YOU GROW OLDER AND ESPECIALLY IF YOU PURSUE SCIENCE, YOU'LL FIND YOURSELF IN THE LABORATORY MORE THAN IN THE CLASSROOM. YOU'LL BE EXPLORING THINGS ON YOUR OWN WITHOUT TEACHERS TELLING YOU WHAT TO DO ANYMORE, AND THAT BECOMES FUN—IT BECOMES SECOND NATURE.

WHY DO YOU THINK WE AREN'T TAKEN TO THE LABS QUITE OFTEN?

I THINK IT'S BECAUSE OF OUR NUMBERS RIGHT NOW. STUDENT NUMBERS—BECAUSE YOU ALL ARE A LOT! ALSO, THE WAY OUR TIMETABLES ARE PLACED. TILL 10TH GRADE, EVEN WHEN I WENT THROUGH SCHOOL, WE WERE TAKEN TO THE LAB MAYBE ONCE OR TWICE IN A YEAR. A LOT OF OUR TEACHERS BROUGHT STUFF TO THE CLASSROOM TO SHOW US, WHICH A LOT OF US STILL DO—REMEMBER THE EXPERIMENTS I BROUGHT TO CLASS? IT'S EASIER TO BRING IT TO YOU BECAUSE WE DON'T HAVE THE SPACE TO ACCOMMODATE SO MANY OF YOU TOGETHER. WHEN YOU GO TO HIGHER CLASSES, YOU HAVE LABS WITH LARGER CAPACITIES TO MATCH THAT.

WOULD IT BE BENEFICIAL IF 7TH OR 8TH GRADERS WERE TAKEN TO THE LAB TO HELP WITH STREAM SELECTION?

I'M NOT SURE IF TAKING THEM TO THE LAB WILL HELP, BECAUSE A LOT OF US WHO TEACH 7TH AND 8TH GRADERS BRING THE EXPERIMENTS STRAIGHT TO CLASS. NINTH AND 10TH GRADERS ARE A LITTLE MORE DISCIPLINED, BUT 6TH AND 7TH GRADERS DON'T TAKE IT THAT SERIOUSLY—FOR THEM, IT'S JUST A FUN THING. WHILE A HANDFUL WILL BE INTERESTED, A LOT MORE WILL HAVE MISCHIEF ON THEIR MINDS AND WANT TO EXPLORE OTHER THINGS RATHER THAN CONCENTRATING ON WHAT THE TEACHER HAS TO SAY. IN A FAMILIAR CLASSROOM, CONCENTRATION IS BETTER. WHEN IT'S NOT FEASIBLE—LIKE SOMETHING WITH FIRE OR A FLAME WHEN I TEACH CHEMISTRY—WE SHOW SIMULATIONS ON THE SMARTBOARD. THEY HAVE AMAZING REACTIONS, SO THEY ARE LEARNING HANDS-ON EITHER WAY.

HOW DO YOU THINK THE LABS CAN BE MADE BETTER?

THERE IS ALWAYS SCOPE FOR IMPROVEMENT. AS TECHNOLOGIES COME UP, WE CAN UPGRADE EQUIPMENT—LIKE GETTING MICROSCOPES WITH HIGHER RESOLUTION OR CREATING MORE WORKSPACE TO ACCOMMODATE MORE PEOPLE. BUT AS IT IS, WHAT I'VE SEEN OF OUR FACILITIES, I THINK WE ARE BLESSED TO HAVE SUCH FABULOUS FACILITIES. IN OTHER SCHOOLS, LABS ARE OFTEN VERY SMALL AND TINY. AT FAPS, THE LIBRARY AND THE LABS ARE TRULY FABULOUS.

WHAT DO YOU THINK ABOUT THE VARIETY OF SPECIMENS IN THE BIO LAB, AND WHAT'S YOUR FAVOURITE SPECIMEN?

THEY ARE MORE THAN ADEQUATE. SINCE WE CATER TO 11TH AND 12TH, AND THERE'S AN OVERLAP WITH KINGDOM CLASSIFICATION FROM 7TH ONWARDS, WE HAVE VIRTUALLY EVERY SPECIMEN. IT'S ONE OF THE BEST-EQUIPPED LABS IN BANGALORE. AS FOR MY FAVOURITE SPECIMEN, I THINK IT WOULD BE THE FETUS—IT'S VERY ANATOMICALLY CORRECT AND QUITE CUTE! THE SKELETON IS FINE, BUT THE FETUS IS TRULY SPECIAL.

-MRS. MANISHA

Riddles and Quotes

1.“Who Am I” of the Week:

The more I lie, the more people trust me. Who am I?

2.You Be The Detective:

A valuable painting is stored in a vault. After a visit from someone with access, its owner finds a plain black canvas in its place. The original canvas has never left the vault. How could the picture have disappeared?

(ANSWERS AT THE LAST PAGE)

THE ONLY MYSTERY IN LIFE IS WHY THE KAMIKAZE PILOTS WORE HELMETS.

-AL MCGUIRE

COMICS

Calvin and Hobbes



Garfield



PEANUTS



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Answers to Riddles:

“Who Am I”: [A politician.]

“You Be The Detective”: [It was painted over. A layer of black paint covered the picture. The original was still there, hidden underneath.]

Comics Source:
https://www.gocomics.com